The Play



Bear Tracks

By the time this issue reaches you, football season will be hitting full stride, and the Golden Bears will have notched three or four wins already, no doubt.

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Certainly many Bears fans see the stars aligning for Cal football. GM **Ron Rivera** is a Cal alum ('89). So is **Tosh Lupoi '05**, the new head coach, whom Rivera hired. So is Chancellor **Rich Lyons '82**, who hired Rivera.



Cal women's water polo came up just short against USC in the NCAA finals in April but beat Stanford en route, their first-ever postseason win over the Cardinal.

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Write For California blogger **Ruey Yen '04** wrote that he wished he could have seen that "inspiring performance" against top-seeded Stanford back in February, before he went on *Jeopardy!* to compete against superchamp Jamie Ding. Alas, Yen, a self-described "baseball usher, sports blogger, and physicist," didn't win.



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If you're not yet acquainted, *Write For California* is the fan-operated website that, in the words of sports scribe **Mike Silver '88**, "covers the hell out of Cal sports like a bear suffocating a tree." If you get the reference, you'll be at home there. The site is also closely associated with the Calgorithm, the fan-driven meme factory we wrote about in our Fall/Winter 2025 issue *(tinyurl.com/3mth9rsn)*.

Got a story for us? Send tips to californiamag@alumni.berkeley.edu.

All eyes continue to be on **Fernando Mendoza '25**, Cal's ex-QB and the No. 1 NFL draft pick last season. In May, the newly minted Raider walked the stage as a special guest at the Haas School of Business's MBA graduation ceremony, where he received his undergraduate diploma. As we reported in our last issue, Mendoza earned his degree from Haas in three years.

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Fewer eyes have been on **Jaydn Ott '25**, another Cal star who transferred via the portal—to Oklahoma. Ott (who also graduated from Cal in three years) went undrafted after a fallow year with the Sooners. He ultimately signed with the Kansas City Chiefs as a free agent.

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That scenario is not uncommon. Less than 2 percent of all Division I football players get drafted. Even some of the very best college players never make it to the pros.

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How many Cal players are currently in the NFL? According to Cal Athletics figures, there were 19 Golden Bears on active rosters as of September 2025.

In the age of NIL and revenue sharing, it should come as no surprise that it's also the age of the college general manager. In addition to Rivera, who's in charge of football operations, the Bears have hired **Meghin Williams** as general manager for women's basketball and **Richard Midgley '06** as deputy general manager for the men's team. Midgley is a former starting guard for the Bears.

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Jaron-Keawe Sagapolutele is under center again this year for Cal. It took money to keep the QB in Berkeley.

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Responsibility for raising the funds largely fell to **Kevin Kennedy, J.D. '91,** president of California Legends, the third-party NIL collective that supports Cal's athletics programs in raising the funds they need for revenue sharing. Kennedy told *The Athletic*, "It wasn't like we had a bake sale. It was really a targeted effort to find that money, and we did it."

"It wasn't like we had a bake sale."

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Cal Athletics reported that it raised $88.5 million in gifts and pledges in 2025–26, with 18 donors pledging $1 million or more each.

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Speaking of general managers, **Eric Tulsky, Ph.D. '02,** is GM of the Carolina Hurricanes, one of the top franchises in the National Hockey League. A scientist who specializes in nanotechnology, Tulsky started with the Hurricanes as a part-time analyst before eventually working his way to the top of the org chart.

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He's not the only one in the front office of a professional franchise. **Paul Toboni '12**, former Cal baseball player, is in his first year as president of baseball operations for the Washington Nationals.

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A former infielder for the Bears, Toboni was part of the last Cal squad to make it to the College World Series, in 2011. They did it with the program on the line, as the university had decided to cut or redesignate five varsity teams that year, including baseball. In the end, donors led by **Stu Gordon '62, J.D. '65,** raised some $9 million to rescue the program. The aluminum bats now ring out in Stu Gordon Stadium.

Another varsity program that was on the chopping block in 2010–11 was women's gymnastics. It too was saved and has done Cal proud since then, making it to its second ACC championship this year, after three straight regular-season Pac-12 titles and a second-place finish in the 2024 NCAA championships.



Remember the student who kicked a 33-yard field goal on *College GameDay* in 2024 while wearing a pair of Vans? Daniel Villaseñor won $100,000 that day. He's on track to graduate from Cal with a degree in civil engineering.



Former Cal shortstop (and later MLB second baseman) Jeff Kent was inducted into the National Baseball Hall of Fame on July 26. He's the first former Cal player to earn the distinction.

LUPOI AND RIVERA: THEARON W. HENDERSON/GETTY IMAGES; WATER POLO: VINCENT LEO/@VINCENTLEOPHOTO; JEOPARDY: COURTESY OF RUEY YEN; GAMEDAY KICK: PHIL ELLSWORTH/ESPN; KENT: AP PHOTO/SETH WENIG



Cal's **Tonya Paulsson** made history at the 2026 ACC Championships by becoming the first freshman in ACC history to win the conference all-around title.

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Cal has won more than 100 national team titles and more than 200 individual titles across its history. It added even more individual champions in 2026, including freshman (and 2024 Olympic veteran) **Claire Weinstein,** who won the NCAA title in the 500-yard freestyle.



One of the biggest sports stories of 2026 was the New York Knicks' NBA championship victory over the San Antonio Spurs. Had things worked out differently, **Jason Kidd** might have coached the Knicks. In 2020, the franchise interviewed the former Cal superstar to take the head coaching spot. They came knocking again in 2025, but the Dallas Mavericks put the kibosh on that.

Two more for the trophy case: In crew, Cal's varsity four won a 2026 Intercollegiate Rowing Association national title. And perennial powerhouse Cal rugby won its 35th national collegiate championship title.

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Another Cal star with a Knicks connection is **Darrall Imhoff '94**. The 6'10" center had the dubious distinction of guarding Wilt Chamberlain the night Chamberlain scored a record 100 points. Afterward, Imhoff said, "I can't have a nightmare tonight. I've just lived through one."

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Imhoff's class year above is correct, by the way. He came back to finish his forestry degree in the '90s. His coach at Cal, Pete Newell, joked, "It only took you 35 years. I thought it would take 45."

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1958–59 was the zenith of Cal Athletics. In addition to its Rose Bowl appearance, Cal, led by Imhoff, won the national basketball crown in 1959.

Rose Bowl quarterback **Joe Kapp '60** played both football and basketball at Cal. His roommate **Earl Robinson '58, M.A. '71,** was also a two-sport letterman, a star in basketball and baseball. He went on to play in the major leagues for the Dodgers and Orioles. He also had the distinction of being the first African American yell leader at Cal.

Anna Bright '21 is an up-and-comer on the pro pickleball circuit. The former Cal varsity tennis player is ranked second in the world in women's doubles.



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The 1959 Rose Bowl team was surprisingly diverse for the times, with Black, Hispanic, and Asian starters.

The sporting event of the summer was the Men's World Cup of soccer, err, football. In the U.S.'s group match against Australia in Seattle, the camera found former Cal varsity soccer players **Alex Morgan '14** and her husband, **Servando Carrasco '15**, in the crowd. Like Morgan (see sidebar), Carrasco played professional soccer for several years. He retired in 2020.

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Also spotted at the Australia game was **Marshawn Lynch**, who once, in the very same stadium, made a 67-yard touchdown run in which he broke nine tackles. The reaction of Seahawks fans was so great it registered 2.0 on the Richter scale. The play is remembered as the Beast Quake.

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Lynch wasn't just a spectator. He was also a credentialed sideline photographer!

For Cal rugby fans, "World Cup" has a different meaning; it's the Bears' annual match against the University of British Columbia. Last spring was the teams' 100th meeting. Cal won. Naturally.

—P.J.





Lady Liberty: A larger-than-life statue of Alex Morgan was erected in New York City to promote the 2023 Women's World Cup.

Taking it to the Man

How Cal's Alex Morgan led the charge on equal pay for U.S. Women's Soccer

When the FIFA Men's World Cup ended on July 19, it was a sad day for soccer fans—and not just because Argentina lost. No, that was fine. It was sad because the whole wonderful spectacle had come to a sudden close, not to return for four long years.

Actually, this summer's soccer pageantry should be a reminder that the 2027 Women's World Cup is now less than a year away. The tournament runs from June 24 through July 25 in Brazil.

While the U.S. men have struggled to break through on the world stage—once again failing to reach the quarterfinals—the U.S. women have long been an international powerhouse, with four FIFA World Cup titles and five Olympic golds to their credit.

They are also early favorites to win it all in Rio.

Many of the athletes behind the U.S. dominance are now household names, including Megan Rapinoe, Carli Lloyd,

Continued on page 21

PAULSSON: KELLEY L COX/KLC FOTOS; WEINSTEIN: JACK SPITSER/CAL ATHLETICS; IMHOFF: CAL ATHLETICS; ROBINSON: CAL ATHLETICS; LYNCH: IMAGN IMAGES VIA REUTERS/STEVEN BISIG; RUGBY: CAIDEN C HUDSON/KLC FOTOS; MORGAN: MICHAEL M. SANTIAGO/GETTY IMAGES



SCOT GOODMAN

Still Rolling

At 50, the Bay Area Outreach and Recreation Program keeps disabled athletes in the game.

By Emma Silvers



Susan Sygall '76 still remembers some of the misguided comments she heard when she started the Bay Area Outreach and Recreation Program.

Sygall, who launched the adaptive sports program as an undergraduate at Berkeley, is an internationally renowned disability rights activist, author, and MacArthur Fellow. BORP is a widely acclaimed 50-year-old sports and recreation nonprofit that has played an influential role in the disability rights movement.

But back in the 1970s, there was skepticism—both about the organization's approach and about its young female director. When BORP began offering horseback riding, Sygall recalls, "People said, 'Oh, isn't it dangerous for disabled people to go horseback riding?'"

She would reply with a quip she'd heard from a quadriplegic BORP participant: "Every disabled person has the right to break their neck twice."

Sygall, now 73, exudes an upbeat, tireless determination. She grew up non-disabled and athletic on the East Coast: she skied, played basketball, and loved to camp. Soon after she enrolled at the University of Colorado, she became paraplegic following a car accident. After a year of rehabilitation and encouragement from her parents—Holocaust survivors who always urged her to live life to its fullest—she spent a year at NYU before transferring to Berkeley in 1973 to complete her degree as part of the Disabled Students' Program.

On the heels of the Free Speech and anti-war movements, the Bay Area was humming with activism. Nationally, Title IX had just prohibited sex-based discrimination in school sports, and Berkeley's Center for Independent Living, a formative hub for the disabled community, had been founded in 1972.

All a blur: All-around athlete, attorney, and BORP executive director Emily Seelenfreund flies past on the handcycle.

Previous page: Sisseline Lovejoy is an Albany High graduate who started playing basketball with BORP at age 11. She'll continue to compete at the University of Arizona.

"Everything is always related," says Sygall of these fights for equality. "Everyone was talking about a revolution."

In 1974, with her friend Deborah Kaplan, J.D. '76, she cofounded the Disabled Women's Coalition to ensure women had a voice in the burgeoning disability rights movement. The following year, while working on an independent study project, she envisioned a recreation program for disabled people—inspired, mainly, by the fact that she couldn't find one that appealed to her as a lifelong athlete.

"I was so passionate about recreation and sports, and I didn't see any opportunities [for] camping in Yosemite, gymnastics, wheelchair basketball, dance, archery, self-defense," recalls Sygall. "It was really just creating all the opportunities that I wanted to do."

With the encouragement of a handful of Berkeley professors, such as landscape architect Robin Moore and education professor John Hurst, she made the project a reality. Her high school friend Diane Schechter flew out to help, and they submitted

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proposals to the Berkeley City Council, receiving two initial grants totaling $25,000.

The pair officially cofounded BORP in 1975 with a handful of programs, including swimming and gymnastics, for disabled kids in Berkeley public schools. One of its founding principles was groundbreaking at the time: People with disabilities should teach the courses, so kids could look up to them as role models and form a "sense of positive identity," says Sygall. "It was so unusual at that time for people to talk about disability pride."

Five decades later, BORP serves some 1,400 people annually with wheelchair basketball teams, kayaking and nature outings, power soccer (an indoor form of soccer played by people in power wheelchairs, a sport that BORP helped establish and popularize), a cycling center with more than 100 adaptive cycles, and transportation and other support services. The organization has helped shift thinking around physical activity away from therapy and toward recreation: sports for the sake of, well, sports.

That distinction has been life-changing for people like Sisseline Lovejoy. Now 18, she's been participating in BORP's basketball programs since she was 11.

"The first time I played basketball, it was pretty obvious to me that it was going to change my life," recalls Lovejoy, a recent graduate of Albany High School. Lovejoy has a genetic condition called hereditary spastic paraplegia, which has progressed over her life; back when she first picked up a ball, she didn't yet use a wheelchair for daily activities. "But I felt really slow and disabled in my day-to-day life, and there was something about being in a chair—[it] was almost like a vessel that was meant to carry me and allow me to move and to be free."

After spending the last few years on BORP's traveling women's team, Lovejoy was recruited to play at the University of Arizona, where she'll start in the fall. "It changed the way I was able to think about myself and what my body can do," Lovejoy says of the organization.

For Emily Seelenfreund, BORP's executive director, the ethos of "by disabled people, for disabled people" is one of the nonprofit's most powerful features.

"A lot of adaptive sports organizations that I've been a part of are very top-down," says Seelenfreund. "But because BORP was founded by people with disabilities, it's always been really attuned to what the community wants and needs."

Most recently, that has meant things like BORP's new micromobility equipment loaner program, which lets people try out expensive new gear, like wheelchair attachments, before purchasing it—an idea Seelenfreund had after shopping for her own device.



Team play: Seelenfreund says BORP's ethos is "by disabled people, for disabled people."

"Every disabled person has the right to break their neck twice."

"It also means there's a real sense of community," says Seelenfreund, noting that she is honored to follow Sygall's lead as a young female director of the organization. "It's not just a place where [people] exercise. It's also a place, very often, where they find lifelong friends and connection."

The tight-knit community makes Sygall emotional when she discusses her time in Berkeley. Deep friendships strengthened the organization's work, she says, and vice versa. In 1977, when renowned disability rights advocate Judy Heumann, MPH '75, co-led a group of activists to occupy a San Francisco federal building for 28 days in order to push through long-delayed anti-discrimination regulations, Sygall, Kaplan, and others from Berkeley didn't hesitate to join the sit-in.

Sygall left BORP in 1978 to spend a year in Australia on a Rotary scholarship, but she says the people she met at the organization indelibly shaped her later work: In 1981, as a grad student at the University of Oregon, she founded Mobility International USA, based on the same principles. It, too, is still going strong, facilitating exchange and development programs for disabled people around the world. Sygall still serves as CEO and has no plans to retire anytime soon.

She will, however, take a few days off in October when she heads back to the Bay Area for BORP's 50th anniversary celebration. Reflecting on the milestone, she's been seeing "all the connections, and how powerful those moments were in Berkeley."

One of the messages she hopes young people take away from her story is "the power of students creating projects." Ideas conceived in school don't have to stay there, she says. "Dream big and surround yourself with great people until those things come true." C

Emma Silvers is a longtime Bay Area culture journalist and cofounder of COYOTE Media Collective.

SCOT GOODMAN

Class Notes



"My name is **Dr. David Law '04**. I'm a physician at Long Beach Memorial, a board member of the Cure GM1 Foundation, and Violet's father. My daughter Violet passed away in 2023 from GM1 gangliosidosis, a rare and fatal pediatric neurodegenerative disease. Like many families, we did not know she had GM1 until irreversible neurologic damage had already occurred. It has now been nearly two years since her passing, and while that loss remains unimaginable, we have continued moving forward through efforts to improve early detection for future children. In May, I was in Sacramento with other families and physicians as State Senator Steve Padilla presented a resolution declaring May 23, 2026, as GM1 Gangliosidosis Awareness Day. A major focus of this advocacy is newborn screening. GM1 is still not included in California's newborn screening panel, despite available testing and emerging therapies. We hope increased awareness can help move that conversation forward." *Ed note:* California *wrote about David and Violet in 2023. Read "I was afraid we'd be isolated."* (tinyurl.com/2upmtw7d)

Dana Cruz '13 was named one of *Comstock's* magazine's 2026 Young Professionals. Dana serves as a governmental affairs attorney for the Judicial Council of California, representing the largest court system in the nation. He has worked across all three branches of state government, including as a fiscal policy advisor to Governors Jerry Brown and Gavin Newsom and a legislative aide to State Senator Janet Nguyen. The son of Filipino immigrants and a first-generation college student, he credits Berkeley with amplifying the curiosity, drive, and sense of public purpose that have since guided his career.

Rachelle Gold, CERT '01, M.A. '02, won a five-year $500,000 grant from the Mellon Foundation to create an oral history archive of Black women justice-seekers who are alumnae of North Carolina Central University, where she has taught English, composition, African American and world literature, and grammar since 2008. So far, she has trained 80 students to conduct oral history interviews of distinguished graduates of NCCU.

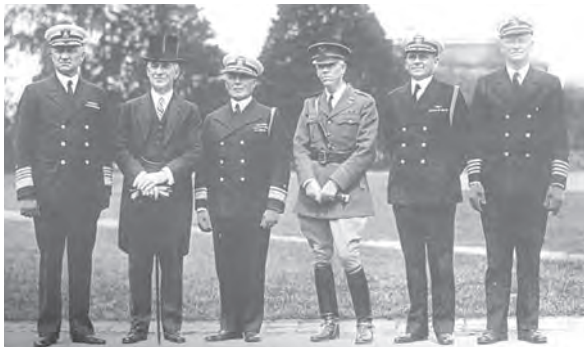
Terry Healey '86 writes: "Thrilled to announce that my latest book, *The Resilience Mindset: How Adversity Can Strengthen Individuals, Teams, and Leaders*, has won a National Indie Excellence Award. I overcame a life-threatening cancer that left me with a permanent facial difference when I was a junior at Berkeley. I encountered roadblocks for years afterwards, enduring over 30 surgical procedures to cure my cancer and attempt to reconstruct my face. My book is based on not just my own story, but those of others who have overcome seemingly insurmountable odds."

Above: **David Law** (second from left) in front of the State Capitol with other members of the Cure GM1 Foundation.



Alan White '69 writes: "Berkeley in the late 1960s was full of local and international concerns, between the war in Vietnam and the many social issues one learns about at UC. Halfway through an MBA, I decided the Peace Corps would be a better option. By 1971, I was learning Spanish and went to Ecuador on an assignment in the Galapagos Islands with the Charles Darwin Foundation. I gravitated to a career in natural resource conservation that has taken me into more than 40 years of research in sustainable marine resource use and various projects in Southeast Asia for coral reef protection and fisheries management. Berkeley was the catalyst that opened my eyes to the world!"

STATE CAPITOL: COURTESY OF DAVID LAW; DIVING: VANGIE WHITE





Inspection visit to Cal NROTC, circa 1927, including **Chester Nimitz** (far right)

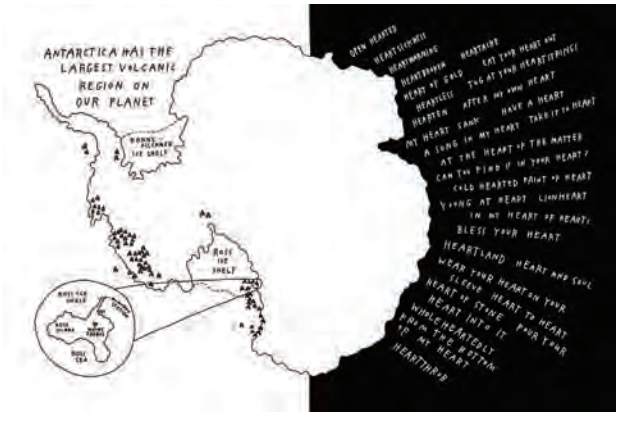
Dennis LaFlam (left) with midshipmen from Cal NROTC in 2026.

Dennis LaFlam '77, former U.S. Navy lieutenant and surface warfare officer, writes: "This year marks the 100th anniversary of Cal's Naval Reserve Officers Training Corps (NROTC), one of six such programs established by the Navy in 1926. The founding commanding officer and the school's first professor of naval sciences was Chester W. Nimitz, who went on to command Allied forces in the Pacific during World War II. The program was located in Callaghan Hall before the building burned down in an arson fire in 1985. Today it is headquartered in Hearst Gymnasium. Cal's NROTC serves a consortium of local schools, also enrolling students from UC Davis, Stanford, and the California Maritime Academy. Applicants selected for the program, upon acceptance to their respective colleges or universities, are awarded scholarships that provide full tuition, books, monthly stipends, and educational fees. Upon graduation, NROTC midshipmen are commissioned as officers in the Navy and Marine Corps. The school's NROTC has distinguished itself as a premier program in training well-rounded officers."

Philip Ballou '76, M.A. '78, Ph.D. '83, feels thankful for the diversity and breadth of his experiences during his 12 years at Cal. While majoring in music composition, he also enjoyed classes in biology and anthropology, as well as participating in the scientific diving program. After being unable to find an academic position in music, he took a summer job at a local marine technology company, and retired from this field 37 successful and fulfilling years later. Later this summer, at the age of 72, he is releasing *Philip Ballou: Selected Works 1977–1983*, a vinyl LP produced by Important Records.

Jonathan Ezra Goldman '94 has published his fourth book, *Hidden Histories of Jazz Age New York: From the Suppressed to the Strange* (SUNY Press Excelsior Editions, May 2026). It offers a fresh look at 1920s New York City, unearthing stories of everyday life and marginalized communities. Sweeping events such as the Harlem Renaissance, Prohibition, and immigration reform are seen through the individual experiences of librarians, cops, shopkeepers, sex workers, ragpickers, and antivaxxers that counter popular conceptions of the era as one of ballooning wealth and uproarious celebration. These stories still resonate today, helping 21st-century readers see our own moment and its problems more clearly.

Jane Clare Upp '49 writes: "We were career-determined when we joined Dean Griffin's journalism class in 1946. Joan (from Piedmont) and I (Bakersfield) were alone in a class of men. I wanted to be a foreign correspondent and Joan wanted to be a reporter. She realized her dream, but my plans went out the window when I started dating a Phi Delt, **John Upp '49**, in 1949. Love overcame career. We had 65 married years together and, though I was no foreign correspondent, I got my teaching credential while having five children and owned Travelwise in Walnut Creek, which got me around the world. I stayed a travel agent for 29 years and wrote many travel articles. Now it is time for a permanent sabbatical."



Outer Space is Closer Than Antarctica **hit bookstores last year. Published by Chronicle Books, this illustrated memoir from Michelle Ott, MFA '15, describes life, love, and the science she learned in the four summer seasons she spent working at Antarctica's largest research base, McMurdo Station. In fact, Michelle learned that outer space is closer than Antarctica while attending an arts talk at Berkeley in 2016.**

NROTC: COURTESY OF DENNIS LAFLAM

The Gate



Julia Gitis '12 kicks off San Francisco Good Neighbor Week on September 26. It runs until October 4. This is the city's second annual Good Neighbor Week, which Julia first championed in 2025 after finding herself the only representative from California on a Zoom call for the nationwide Good Neighbor Day of September 28. Find out more about this year's San Francisco Good Neighbor Week or nominate a deserving neighbor for the Good Neighbor Awards at *sfgoodneighborweek.org*.

Andrea Louie, M.A. '91, Ph.D. '96, has published her third book, *Chinese American Mothering: Toy Len Goon's Legacy and the Myth of the Model Minority*. She writes about her great-grandmother, Toy Len Goon, who won the 1952 Maine and National Mother of the Year awards. Andrea examines how her ancestor's story was used at the time to reinforce ideas about minorities and opportunity, as well as how Goon's descendants think of her legacy in a modern setting.

Philip L. Glick '75, a professor of surgery at the University at Buffalo's Jacobs School of Medicine and Biomedical Sciences, has endowed a new lecture series on the business of surgery. He writes: "While at Berkeley as an undergraduate, Professors Seymour Fogel (genetics) and John Hearst (chemistry) and graduate student **Thomas R. Cech, Ph.D. '75,** (Nobel Prize in Chemistry, 1989) were important role models and mentors to me. Later, as a mid-career surgeon, I got an MBA. The Jacobs School of Medicine asked me to champion the M.D.–MBA dual degree program as its liaison with the School of Management. During that time, we graduated dozens of M.D.–MBAs and started the accelerated MBA for residents and fellows. In medical school, there is an emphasis on scientific, clinical, ethical, and psycho-motor skill sets. But the curriculum is deficient in the essential business skills that surgeons need as opportunities for leadership come along."

Submit your own note at *alumni.berkeley.edu/submit-a-class-note*. Need a prompt? Tell us about your favorite place to study when you were at Cal.

COURTESY OF JULIA GITIS

TELL THE WHOLE DAMN WORLD!

PODCAST



What makes Cal such an extraordinary place?

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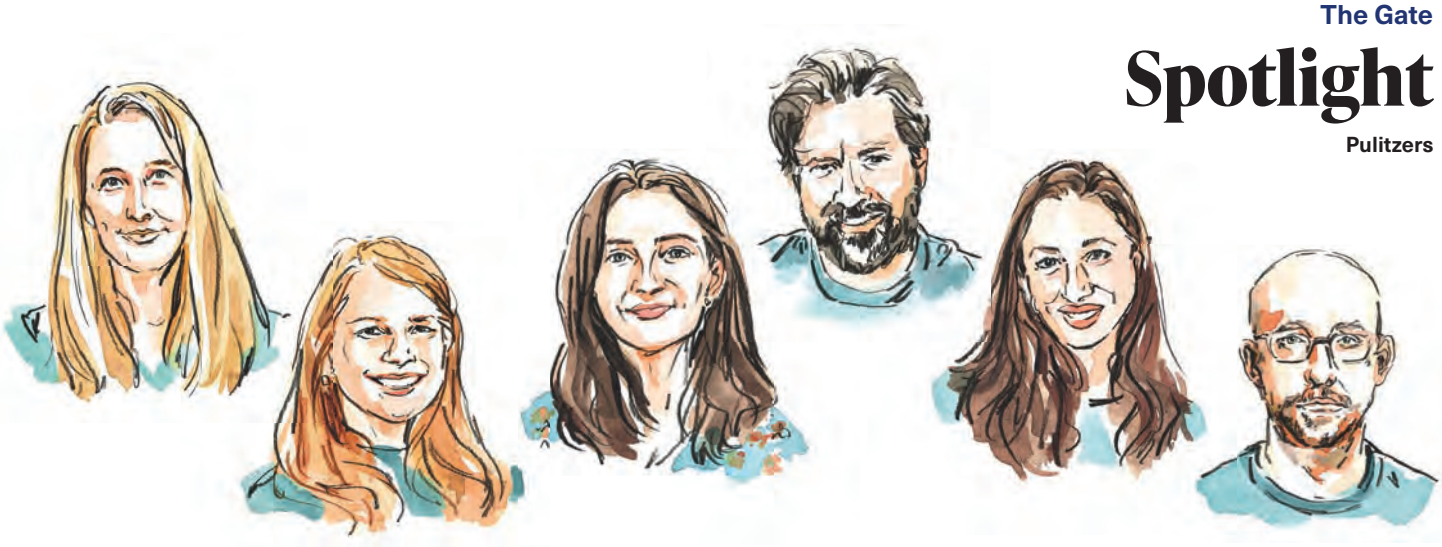
Go beyond the games with fun and inspiring stories from the athletes, coaches, and other remarkable people who love the University of California!

TellTheWholeDamnWorld.com

The podcast that celebrates all things Cal!

Spotlight

Pulitzers



As a reporter and now editor of the *Washington Post*'s rapid-response investigations unit, **Emma Brown, M.J. '09,** has garnered several major headlines since President Trump first took office in 2017. Last year, she was part of the team that won the Breaking News Reporting Pulitzer for coverage of the assassination attempt on then-candidate Trump in Pennsylvania. In 2021, she helped unveil what happened during the January 6 insurrection—work that won the *Post* another Pulitzer. And in 2018, she broke the story of sexual assault allegations against then–Supreme Court nominee Brett Kavanaugh. Colleagues praised Brown's empathy in researching that piece, which required gaining the confidence of informant Christine Blasey Ford. Earlier in her career, Brown was an education reporter, a U.S. Forest Service ranger, and a middle school math teacher in Alaska.

At 8:27 a.m. on August 27, 2025, shots rang out at the Annunciation Catholic Church and School in Minneapolis. By 10:15 a.m., the staff at the *Minnesota Star Tribune*, led by editor **Kathleen Hennessey, M.J. '04,** had confirmed the deaths of two children in the mass shooting, which also left 21 injured. Their subsequent body of work won this year's Pulitzer Prize for Breaking News. No stranger to on-the-ground reporting (or to Minnesota, where her family is from), Hennessey previously led a team of national Associated Press reporters who lived in the places they wrote about. A gifted political editor and reporter, she spent most of her career in Washington, D.C., where she covered the Obama administration and Trump's first term in the White House for outlets including the *New York Times*.

Susie Neilson, M.J. '19, a science writer turned investigative reporter and self-proclaimed "data person," became a Pulitzer finalist in 2025. This year, the *San Francisco Chronicle* staffer shared the prize in Explanatory Reporting for exposing how insurance companies leave California wildfire survivors without the means to rebuild their homes. Neilson combed through thousands of pages of records and found that the state's largest companies were knowingly using faulty algorithms to set inadequate coverage limits. Maggie Beidelman, M.J. '13, aided as a visuals editor. In her spare time, Neilson mentors Berkeley Journalism students in the Investigative Reporting Program. Being recognized by the Pulitzer Prize Board, she told the J-school, has left her with "the increased confidence that I can take big swings."

Contributing to the *Star Tribune*'s win this year was **Andy Mannix, M.J. '15**. Upon being hired by the paper in 2016, Mannix focused on "cops, courts, and prisons," later joining the paper's investigations team. In 2020, he coauthored a piece on how the death of George Floyd exposed a long-standing culture of misconduct in the Minneapolis Police Department. Mannix's story helped the *Star Tribune* win the 2021 Pulitzer for Breaking News Reporting and the prestigious George Polk Award in 2020. Earlier this year, Mannix made the move to *ProPublica*, where he remains committed to accountability journalism in the region. "The flurry of recent national news out of Minneapolis is just the latest indicator of how critical the Midwest is to understanding the changing story of America."

Across China, people deemed troublemakers can't leave their homes without their every move being watched. How does the government keep an eye on them? **Garance Burke, M.J. '04, MPP '05,** along with four others at the Associated Press, won the Pulitzer in International Reporting this year for revealing the surprising answer: China largely built its surveillance system on technology purchased from companies based in the U.S. What's more, they discovered, the U.S. Border Patrol monitors drivers with the very same technology and, relying on predictive policing, detains those with "suspicious" travel patterns. Video producer Serginho Roosblad, M.J. '18, contributed to the investigation. Burke, who in addition to the J-school also studied at Berkeley's Goldman School of Public Policy, received the GSPP alumni award for Exceptional Leadership in Policy and Journalism in 2018.

ProPublica national desk reporter **Brett Murphy, M.J. '16,** is no stranger to the Pulitzer, bestowed annually by Columbia University. In 2024, he shared the Public Service prize for revealing that some Supreme Court justices received lavish gifts, which led to the court adopting its first-ever code of conduct. He received his first Pulitzer nod in 2018, becoming a finalist for a *USA Today* series on the exploitation of port truckers—reporting he began at the Berkeley J-school. Mentored by faculty, Murphy uncovered numerous labor violations committed against the predominately immigrant workforce, including pressuring employees to sign contracts without translation and locking gates to force them to work overtime. Murphy credited the bravery of his subjects, who he said "risked everything to tell us their story."

—H.J.V.

ILLUSTRATIONS BY **HEATHER GATLEY**

In Memoriam

50 Louise (Brooks) Rasmussen, May 5, in Oakland. Louise left her hometown of Red Bluff to attend Cal and never looked back. In 1949, when she was a Tri Delta living across the street from the International House, she joined the I-House chorus. While singing Christmas carols, she met the love of her life, John Rasmussen, Ph.D. '52. They were married in 1950 and welcomed twin girls the following year. They had two more children and spent most of their lives in Berkeley. After returning to Cal for her teaching credential, Louise taught sixth grade for two decades. She was predeceased by her daughter Jane '73, J.D. '76. She is survived by her husband, John; her children, Nancy '73, David '76, and Stephen; three grandchildren; and two great-grandchildren.

51 Peter F. Neumeyer, M.A. '55, Ph.D. '63, April 2, in Santa Rosa. Though Peter published scholarly works on subjects including Franz Kafka, Thomas Mann, and Shakespeare, his true passion was children's literature. At San Diego State University, he established one of the leading children's literature programs in the country and furthered the development of the field, for which he received the Children's Literature Association's Anne Deveraux Jordan Award. Peter published more than a dozen books for children and adults, including *The Annotated Charlotte's Web*. After retiring, he became a prolific reviewer of children's books. He was the loving husband of Helen for 74 years; the proud father of Zachary, Christopher, and Daniel; and the grandfather of Max, Joseph, Ravi, and Emily.

58 Merrill L. Bobele, May 8, in San Diego. Merrill is survived by his wife, Joanne; his sons, Michael Aaron and Jay Eden; and his four grandchildren.

62 Benjamin F. Blair, May 26, in Denver, CO. During his career in real estate development and brokerage, Ben served as president of both the Topeka Area and Kansas Associations of Realtors, and as regional vice president and treasurer of the National Association of Realtors. He received NAR's Distinguished Service Award in 1997. An ardent advocate for self-determination, Ben chose to conclude his 13-year journey with ALS under Colorado's Medical Aid in Dying law, writing, "I believe we live on in how we treated people and what we left behind." Ben is survived by his beloved wife of 36 years, Marice, and their dog, Professor; his sister, Barrie; and his daughters, Amy, Shelly, and Katherine. He also leaves behind seven granddogs and great-granddogs.



Mary Lovelace O'Neal, May 10, in Mérida, Mexico. In 1985, Mary became the first African American artist to get tenure in the Berkeley art department. In 1999, she was appointed chair of the department, and retired from teaching in 2006.

Mary was born in Jackson, Mississippi, in 1942 and studied at Howard University as a young woman, where she dated, and was influenced by, Black student leader Stokely Carmichael. She went on to earn her MFA at Columbia and became involved with the Black Arts Movement in New York City.

At Columbia, she began to develop her *Lampblack* series of monochromes, which involved applying layers of lampblack (soot from burned oil) on canvases until they were, in Mary's words, "as black as they could be."

Her work, often executed on wall-sized canvases, wasn't always Black enough, politically speaking, for many of her fellow Black artists. But, as she told an interviewer in the *Times Style* magazine, "I didn't try to make work for Black people or brown people or white people or red people or yellow people or crazy people. I was there to deal with my stuff, to deal with *me*."

After *Lampblack*, she broke from minimalism, launching a series of vibrant abstract paintings she called *Whales Fucking*. The X-rated title was inspired by a whale sighting she made from the beach after moving to Oakland. She said it caused her to wonder how much water the giant mammals displaced during copulation. In the late 1980s, she embarked on a celebrated series titled *Panthers in my Father's Palace*, inspired by a visit to Morocco, and, late in life, another called *HECHO EN MÉXICO—a mano*, produced in her studio in the Yucatán.

She found joy in her work, once remarking that "painting with color was always a surprise. [It was] like dancing with the paint."

Mary's works have been widely exhibited and are housed in several permanent collections, including at the National Gallery of Art, the Smithsonian, SFMOMA, and the de Young Museum.

63 Robert Clough, M.S. '63, April 29, in San Ramon. During his 37-year career at Lawrence Livermore National Laboratory, Robert was a giant of the nuclear testing era. His contributions to the safety of this country are immeasurable. He is survived by his wife, Carolyn '63; three children; and two grandchildren.

Dennis G. Erickson, March 17, in Portland, OR. After serving in the Navy during the Korean War, Dennis used the G.I. Bill to enroll in the architecture program at Cal, where he was a member of Phi Kappa Tau. Upon graduating, he moved to Stockholm, Sweden, for a year to work for Kooperativ Forbundet on multifamily housing. Dennis spent the majority of his career at the San Francisco firm Wurster, Bernardi & Emmons. Valuing his Swedish heritage, he was an active member of several Bay Area Swedish organizations. Dennis is survived by his wife of 50 years, Barbara; his son, Carl; and his daughter-in-law, Anita.

Carol Guze (Konrad), Ph.D. '63, June 19, in Novato. Carol was a longtime professor of biology and an administrator at California State University, Dominguez Hills. She was also a clinical medical geneticist and a member of Phi Beta Kappa and Sigma Xi. She studied lichens, practiced and taught yoga, and supported civil and women's rights. Carol is survived by her children, Robin and Hans; five grandchildren; and one great-grandchild.

John McLaughlin, M.A. '63, July 28, in Silver Spring, MD. Born in Glasgow, Scotland, John immigrated to the United States in 1958. He earned an associate degree from Boston University and applied to Harvard, assuming it was somewhere in Ohio. He was astonished to learn it was just across the Charles River. During the Vietnam era, he was among those removed from their teaching positions for their political views, but later returned to academic life in the English department at East Stroudsburg University. For decades, he hosted and produced a weekly folk music program called *Roots and Wings*. John was predeceased by his brothers Stirling, David, Tommy, Andy, Robert, and George; his first wife, Lois; and his granddaughter Nika. He is survived by his wife, Jamie; his children, David, Caitlin, Alysoun, and Stirling; his grandchildren Lydia, Benjamin, Catherine, Alaric, and Teji; and his brother Bill.

Alice Wingwall, MFA '63, Feb. 13, at The Sea Ranch. Long after losing her physical sight to retinitis pigmentosa, Alice used her "mind's eye"

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to develop images in her head. She called her decision to keep working "a radical choice, a political move." Her work has been exhibited at the Berkeley Art Museum and Pacific Film Archive, the Exploratorium, and the Museum of Fine Arts, Boston. Alice loved all shades of red, orange, and pink and, in keeping with her spirit, frequently wore them together. She was predeceased by her sister Sally and was survived by her husband, Berkeley Professor Emeritus Donlyn Lyndon, now deceased. She is survived by her sister Betsy; her brother, Bill; her three children, Andrew, Audrey, and Laura; her five grandchildren, Nicholas, Isabel, Kenneth, Olive, and Ada; and her fourth guide dog, Buttercup.

64 **Jill Brady Deal,** Nov. 8, 2025, in Newport Beach. Jill's husband, Timothy Deal '62, served as a foreign service officer, which took Jill and her two sons, Christoper and Bart '94, around Latin America and Europe. After tours in Tegucigalpa, Honduras, and Warsaw, Poland, her family returned to Washington, D.C., where Jill attended Catholic Law at night. When her family moved to the United Kingdom and France, she became one of the first spouses of a U.S. diplomat to practice law outside the embassy. Jill is survived by her husband of 61 years, Timothy; her oldest son, Chris; and four grandchildren.

65 **John R. Gibson,** Jan. 21, in San Diego. John was a fifth-generation Californian, a resident of Folsom, and a proud Cal Man.

66 **Robert Brinkworth,** Jan. 26. Robert was a member of the track team at Cal. He was also active in the Order of the Golden Bear, the Californians, and Theta Delta Chi. After graduating, he did one tour of duty in the intelligence unit of the Army in Quy Nhon, Vietnam. Robert was predeceased by his two brothers, George and William, and his ex-wife, Connie. He will be missed by his wife, Gail; three children, Jennifer, Chris, and Pamela; two stepchildren, Dan and Ashley; and ten grandchildren.

Robert Ross, M.S. '69, April 14, in San Jose. After receiving his mechanical engineering degrees at Cal, Bob worked for 38 years at General Electric, where he was responsible for the recirculation systems for nuclear energy plants. Bob loved Cal, sharing his enthusiasm with friends and family through the school's amazing rugby team. He is survived and eternally loved by his wife, Carrie; three daughters; six grandchildren; and three great-grandchildren.

Phil Winslow, May 19, in Walnut Creek. Phil's friendliness was his calling card. He could start conversations with complete strangers and make it feel like they were longtime acquaintances. After earning an accounting degree at Cal, Phil worked for the IRS, then had a private accounting practice for over 50 years. A passionate supporter of the university and its athletic programs, he was rarely without his Cal hat. Phil is survived by his wife, Bev '66; his children, Jeffrey and Janna; and his grandchildren, Melania and Nieves.

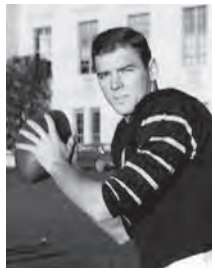
Tim T.Y. Wong, M.S. '66, Feb. 10, in Sacramento. Tim was a research entomologist who used biological and chemical means to reduce agricultural crop damage from pests while minimizing exposure risks to humans and the environment. He was part of the team that eradicated the Mediterranean fruit fly infestation in California during the early 1980s. Tim also helped solve other pest infestation problems in Central America, Africa, and the Pacific Islands. He had over 100 peer-reviewed publications to his name and retired from the USDA after 26 years of service. Tim is survived by his wife, Effie; six children; and one grandchild.

67 **Bob Wieder,** M.A. '75, April 12. Bob came early to the job of making people laugh and stayed at it late. In the '60s, he was editor of the *California Pelican*, the Berkeley humor magazine. He was a lifelong freelance writer, which is sometimes a euphemism for being frequently unemployed. Not in Bob's case. He was always working, including producing the annual "Celebrity Christmas Carols" parodies for *Playboy* in the '70s, authoring *The Oakland A's: The First Twenty-Five Years*, and maintaining a blog he called *Humor Me II*, the successor to *Humor Me*.

68 **Peter S. Munoz,** M.A. '70, J.D. '75, May 26, in Oakland. Peter was a Golden Bear through and through. He was a member of the University Library Board, served on the committee for the Class of '68 Center for Civility and Democratic Engagement, and belonged to the Order of the Golden Bear. Peter attended every Big Game since 1962, and one of his proudest moments was carrying the Axe off the field as a member of Rally Comm at the 1967 game. Cal was one of the great passions of his life, and he found a way to bring it into nearly every conversation he had. He is survived by his wife of over 50 years, Jane '68, J.D. '71; three children, Peter B. '02, Mary '03, and Thomas '03; and four grandchildren.

69 **Ronald K. Tauber,** Ph.D. '69, Jan. 26, in Santa Rosa. While studying criminology at Berkeley, Ron volunteered at Suicide Prevention, later becoming its executive director. The organization is today the Crisis Support Services of Alameda County. Throughout Ron's tenure, he worked to establish a suicide barrier on the Golden Gate Bridge, wondering if it would ever happen in his lifetime. In 2024, a safety net was completed, spanning all 1.7 miles of the bridge. Ron is survived by his wife, Frances; his two children; his stepdaughter; six grandchildren; and his sister.

Charlie Cunningham, June 2, in San Anselmo. After Charlie realized that cars were hurting the planet (during his one and only acid trip, on a mountain in Colorado), he devoted himself to a life without using them and began building bikes in 1977. The Berkeley engineering dropout innovated the "klunkers" of early mountain biking and cofounded one of the first mountain bike component companies, Wilderness Trail Bikes, in 1982. He later focused on making custom bikes, producing 188 in his career. It was while testing one he had made for his wife, the mountain biking champion Jacquie Phelan, that Charlie crashed, resulting in a brain bleed that impaired his vision and balance. He managed to return to the trails by riding tandem with his wife or friends. He is survived by his wife of 38 years, Jacquie.



Craig Morton '64, May 9, in Mill Valley. Five former Cal quarterbacks have gone on to start in NFL Super Bowls—more than from any other college program. Craig was one of them. Unlike the others, however, he played in two championship games, and for two different franchises.

He led the Dallas Cowboys to Super Bowl V (1971) and the Denver Broncos to Super Bowl XII (1978). Both games were losses for the 6'4" playcaller, but he would still earn a Super Bowl ring as a backup for the Cowboys in 1972.

All told, Craig played 18 seasons in the NFL, retiring from the Broncos in 1982.

At Cal, he played for head coaches Marv Levy and Ray Willsey and assistant Bill Walsh. In his 1962 debut as a sophomore against Penn State, he came off the bench to throw for 274 yards and three touchdowns. Despite stellar individual performances, however, he never played on a winning team at Berkeley. In 1964, his senior season, he led the nation in passing yards, but the Bears went 3–7 on the year. Nevertheless, Craig, who also played baseball at Cal, was selected as an All-American and picked fifth overall in the 1965 draft.

In 2013, unhappy with the terms of the NFL's concussion settlement with former players, Craig filed his own suit against the league. He told *SFGATE* at the time, "I came to the conclusion that if I have to step forward and get them to trial to deal with these issues, I will."

He is survived by his wife, Kym; his children, Michael and McKenna; and his grandchildren.

71 **Alan Gribben,** Ph.D. '74, May 9, in Montgomery, AL. As a graduate assistant at the Mark Twain Papers and Project at Bancroft Library, Alan became fascinated with the mystery surrounding the author's literary influences. For his dissertation, he set off on a quest to track down Mark Twain's library. Nearly 50 years later, in 2019 and 2022, he published in two volumes the nearly 6,000 written works that Twain had read and referenced throughout his life. That monumental project earned him accolades just years after he ignited controversy for replacing a racial

JIM EDELEN/MEDIANEWS GROUP/OAKLAND TRIBUNE VIA GETTY IMAGES

slur with the word "slave" in a revised edition of *The Adventures of Tom Sawyer* and *Adventures of Huckleberry Finn*. His aim, he said, wasn't to sanitize literature, but to return the sometimes banned books to classrooms and libraries. In 2025, he and his wife and frequent collaborator, Irene Wong, followed up with an edition of *Tom Sawyer* and *Huckleberry Finn* that made the dialogue more comprehensible to modern readers. Alan is survived by his wife, Irene; his children, Walter and Valerie; his brother, John; and two grandsons, Elliot and Theodore.

79 **John Bengtson,** MBA '81, Jan. 29, in Pleasant Hill. Known as the Sherlock Holmes of silent movies, John tracked down where countless scenes from the classics were filmed. He began his sleuthing in the late '90s, without Google Maps or streaming. It took him four years to put together his first book of film-location finds, *Silent Echoes: Discovering Early Hollywood Through the Films of Buster Keaton*. In his day job, he did pro bono copyright work for California Lawyers for the Arts. But his film projects were his life's work. For his final project, he did a year-by-year analysis of the filming locations used by Stan Laurel and Oliver Hardy. By then too weakened by ALS, he used an AI clone to narrate the final volume. John is survived by his daughters, Linden and Arden, and his older brother, Bruce.

82 **Alicia Queen,** June 22. Alicia was devoted to advocacy and justice. She spent many years providing court-appointed representation through the Superior Court of Alameda County, the Alameda County Bar Association, and the Judicial Council of California. She then served as an associate trial attorney at Farmers Insurance until her retirement in 2024. A long-standing member of Alcoholics Anonymous, Alicia marked over 30 years of sobriety. Her commitment to AA was not only a personal triumph but also a testament to her desire to give back to the community. Alicia was predeceased by her brother, David. She is survived by her partner, Michael; her sisters, Laurie and Leslie; and her foster son, Eric, and his son, EJ.

86 **Brandon Todd Yee,** May 14, in Oakland. Most recently, Brandon was the CEO of Golden Link Concessionaire, LLC, the company that built and maintains the Presidio Parkway. In his career, he worked on the Richmond–San Rafael Bridge, the San Francisco–Oakland Bay Bridge Self-Anchored Span, and the Airport Rail Transit Guideway at San Francisco International Airport. Brandon is survived by his wife, Candy '87; his sons, Jameson and Griffin; and his brother, Gordon '83.

03 **Ryan R. Waterman,** J.D. '03, MCP '03, Feb. 9, in San Diego. Ryan was committed to service. He spent much of his career in the natural resources department of Brownstein Hyatt Farber Schreck, where he took on CEQA issues; renewable energy projects; and land use, water quality, and hazardous substances matters. He ran a successful quarterly newsletter called *CEQA News You Can Use*. His legal practice meant a great deal to him, and he continued working full-time even through cancer treatment. Ryan was also a lifelong supporter of mentoring, particularly through Big Brothers Big Sisters. He first became a Big Brother to Daniel in 1996 and later to Paris, Garrett, and Marvin, creating lifelong relationships he treasured. Ryan is survived by his wife, Julia, M.J. '00; their children, Ben, Luke, and Kate; his mother, Donna; and his sister, Darlene.

18 **Marcus Alan Owens,** Ph.D. '18, Aug. 26, 2025. Marcus and his wife, Christina Antiporda, founded their own studio, CAMO, to implement placemaking projects for the government and local communities. Marcus later worked for the U.S. Forest Service in Kamiah, Idaho, where he designed the landscape surrounding the Nez Perce-Clearwater National Forest supervisor's building. He was also an assistant professor of landscape architecture at Washington State University. Marcus is survived by his wife, Christina; his daughters, Simona and Katharine; his parents, Vera and Marcus; his siblings, Emily and Christopher; and his parents-in-law, Lea and Celso.

26 **Paloma Fabiana Guadalupe Foster,** June 21. Paloma died in a car crash near San Quentin. After experiencing incarceration and emancipation from the foster care system on her 18th birthday, Paloma became a Regents' and Chancellor's Scholar at Cal. A political science major, she dreamed of earning both a J.D. and a master's in public policy so she could improve the decisions affecting foster youth and formerly incarcerated people. She hoped to one day become a foster parent herself. Above all, she worked to build a life that made her two sons proud of their mother. Paloma is survived by her beloved sons, Micah and Cairo; her partner, Shiloh; and her best friends and chosen family, Marlo and Karen.

27 **William Yi Lu,** April 21. William was a valued member of the theater community on campus. He developed his interest in theater while taking Fundamentals of Acting II. Fellow students described him as "full of energy," a "ball of light," and a "one-in-a-million person."

Harshita Nair, June 11. Harshita was a legal studies student and rising senior. As a Diversity, Equity, Inclusion and Justice intern in the ASUC Office of the President, she worked on serving the campus community. Harshita went by the nickname Khushi at home, which roughly translates to "joy" in English. She was the beloved daughter of Ashok and Vanita and a cherished sister and granddaughter.

FACULTY AND STAFF

Anne-Therese Ageson '67, July 3, in Oakland. An expert in child welfare, Anne-Therese taught for 13 years in Berkeley's School of Social Welfare as a lecturer, field consultant, and head of the Title IV-E Child Welfare Scholars Program. Her mantra (and bumper sticker) was that "children should be seen, heard, and believed." She had previously spent more than 20 years as a social work supervisor for Contra Costa County. Upon her retirement from Berkeley, the California Assembly recognized her contributions to the state with a resolution. Anne-Therese was also active in politics, frequently working as an election manager for local campaigns and serving a stint as chair of the Richmond Planning Commission. She supported female candidates at all levels and held leadership positions in the National Women's Political Caucus and the National Organization for Women. Anne-Therese partnered with John



Michael May, Ph.D. '52, May 17, in San Francisco. When Michael reported for his first day at Lawrence Livermore National Laboratory in 1952, he learned what he would be working on: nuclear weapons. "My jaw dropped."

From initially doing theoretical calculations for "the guts of the weapon," he rose up the ranks, becoming the lab's fifth director in 1965. During the tumultuous era, he promoted dialogue. When he spoke about nuclear weapons with faculty and students, he would matter-of-factly lay out the possible nuclear strategies, with their associated risks, benefits, and feasibility. The least bad choice, he concluded, was having a nuclear weapon deterrent—but not using it. "Predictably, I'd always backed that policy, the best of the possibilities." When demonstrators accused Michael of war crimes, he took it in stride. "I thought it was understandable they would have that feeling." But also: "I thought that most of them were ignorant of the real situation."

In the 1970s and '80s, as the lab's first associate director at large, he increasingly lent his scientific expertise to discussions of arms control, including at the Strategic Arms Limitation Talks with the Soviet Union in Geneva. He argued that the U.S. could safely slash its arsenal of strategic nuclear weapons by half, a goal reached during George H. W. Bush's administration.

"Nuclear deterrence policy," Michael said, "is a product of decisions by people, repeatedly, over many years. So, if anything is moral, or immoral, or some of both, that is it."

Michael was predeceased by his wife, Mary, and his sister, Bella. He is survived by his brother, François; his four children; and his longtime companion, Professor Emerita Gail Lapidus.

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Hadreas '77 in 1973. After John graduated from Berkeley with a degree in classics with an emphasis in ancient Greek, he opened Aardvark Books in San Francisco and ran it for 40 years. Together, Anne-Therese and John were Golden Bears for 52 years. They watched and attended football games until John's passing on March 2, 2025. Anne-Therese remained a loyal fan, spending her last Christmas Eve watching the Cal game. She was predeceased by her sister Mary. The couple is survived by their daughter, Anne-Catherine '03; their son-in-law, Patrick '03, M.S. '06; John's brother, Peter '66, Ph.D. '75; and Anne-Therese's sister Ruth and her brother, Martin '76.

Ching-Shui Cheng, June 7. Ching-Shui was a renowned statistician and a leader in contemporary experimental design. He joined the Berkeley faculty in 1977. After taking early retirement, he returned to Taiwan, where he established a joint data science program between Academia Sinica and National Taiwan University to train future generations of statisticians and data scientists in his home country.

Richard James Felciano, Feb. 21, in San Francisco. Rico relished being something of a musical heretic. He pioneered the use of TV as a compositional medium; introduced electronic sounds to sacred music at St. John the Divine in New York; and devised scores informed by his love of modernist design, their text always set in Helvetica. In 1987, he founded the Center for New Music and Audio Technologies at Berkeley. Rico was predeceased by his brother, Joseph. He is survived by his wife, Rita; his sons, Ramon and Manoel; and his granddaughters, Astrid and Vera.

Judith Marie Frank, CERT '80, May 29, in Sacramento. As the assistant director of financial aid, Judith worked with donors to support Berkeley students. Prior to her tenure, she was the communications leader for Kaiser Permanente Northern California, where she founded and served as managing editor of the employee journal *Visions*, which enabled hundreds of nurses to publish their own experiences. She is survived by her husband, Brent '76.

Michael Freeling, July 20. From early work on anaerobic genes and transposons, Michael changed his focus to plant comparative genomics and understanding evolutionary trends. He was elected to the U.S. National Academy of Sciences in 1994 and won the McClintock Prize for Plant Genetics and Genome Studies in 2017.

Donlyn Lyndon, April 5, at The Sea Ranch. Donlyn was the last surviving member of the original design team of The Sea Ranch, the planned community rooted in ecological design on the Northern California coast. His firm, Moore, Lyndon, Turnbull and Whitaker, and fellow Berkeley professor Joseph Esherick were selected as architects of the first buildings, which used vertical redwood cladding and slanted shed roofs to become part of the landscape. Donlyn continued adding homes to the community throughout his career and stewarded its growth as a member of the Sea Ranch Design Committee. Donlyn taught architecture and urban design at Berkeley from 1960 to 1964 and 1979 until his retirement in 2004. In 1997, he received the AIA/ACSA Topaz Medallion, the highest award in architectural education. He was predeceased by his wife, artist Alice Wingwall, MFA '63.

Jasper Kim, July 9. Jasper lectured at Berkeley Law on negotiation, business law, and AI strategy. Prior to entering academia, he worked as a banker and lawyer with global investment firms including Lehman Brothers, Barclays Capital, and Credit Suisse.

Scott Logan, June 17, in Pleasant Hill. A lifelong East Bay resident, Scott was deeply connected to the community he called home. Scott managed facilities projects for schools, serving Cal, San Ramon Valley Unified, and Saint Mary's College in his career. Scott is survived by his son, Christopher; daughter, Danielle; sister, Colleen; and brother, Gregg.

James Midgley, June 21. After growing up in South Africa during apartheid, James started his career doing frontline social work. He helped establish a program in social policy and planning for developing countries at the London School of Economics and later became the dean of the School of Social Welfare at Berkeley. He spent his life insisting that a society is measured by how it treats its people with the least.

Elijah Lucien Polak, M.Eng. '59, D.Eng. '61, June 12. Elijah was a co-creator of the Polak-Ribière method, an algorithm that remains a fundamental tool in mathematical optimization and modern machine learning applications. During his six decades at Cal, he cemented Berkeley's reputation as a world leader in control systems and optimization.

Graham H. Powell, June 15. Dubbed "Mr. Nonlinear" by his colleagues, Graham was a visionary in earthquake engineering, transforming how the profession understands the response of structures under seismic loads. Through his leadership in developing the DRAIN software at Berkeley, and his later collaboration on industry-standard tools like Perform3D, Graham bridged the gap between mathematical theory and practical, life-saving engineering applications.

Ruth Stimson, Aug. 24, in Berkeley. As a professor at the Berkeley School of Public Health, Ruth helped prepare generations of future health-care leaders through the school's hospital administration curriculum. She was committed to improving the quality of patient care and incorporated both objective and subjective measures into her classes. Ruth was predeceased by her husband, David, Ph.D. '65, and her brother, Bob.



Robert Cole, July 11. Robert had a clear goal for Cal Performances when he became its director in 1986: "I had the idea to make [Berkeley] more like a London, New York, or Paris, where the greatest artists come from all over the world," he told KQED.

Seeing few singers in recent programming, one of the first artists he thought of was Leontyne Price, the legendary soprano and prima donna. When Robert called to book her, her agent said he thought Cal Performances hadn't been interested. Robert set the record straight. "That's before *me*. Just cross that out. We *are* interested. I want Leontyne."

Cal Performances hosted her along with many others over the 23 years that Robert was at the helm: the Kronos Quartet, Renée Fleming, Yo-Yo Ma's Silkroad Ensemble, the Bolshoi Ballet, Mikhail Baryshnikov, Cecilia Bartoli. "We were witnessing the 'arrival' of Lincoln Center at Berkeley," a faculty member wrote.

The common thread, season after season, was Robert's educated taste. His father, who died in a car accident before he was born, had left behind a child-size violin. Robert traded that for the double bass, then the saxophone and clarinet. By his senior year in high school, he was a proper working musician, playing twelve shows a week at a high-end nightclub in San Jose. In his late 30s, he was studying conducting with Leonard Bernstein.

He was glad that a career in conducting never panned out. As he told the *San Francisco Chronicle* in 2007, when he announced that the curtain would soon be closing on his long reign in Berkeley, "Unless you're at the very top level of the field, you end up conducting this orchestra and that orchestra and it's kind of routine." But at Cal Performances, he said, he'd been able to work internationally, with art in all its forms. "I like to do different things."

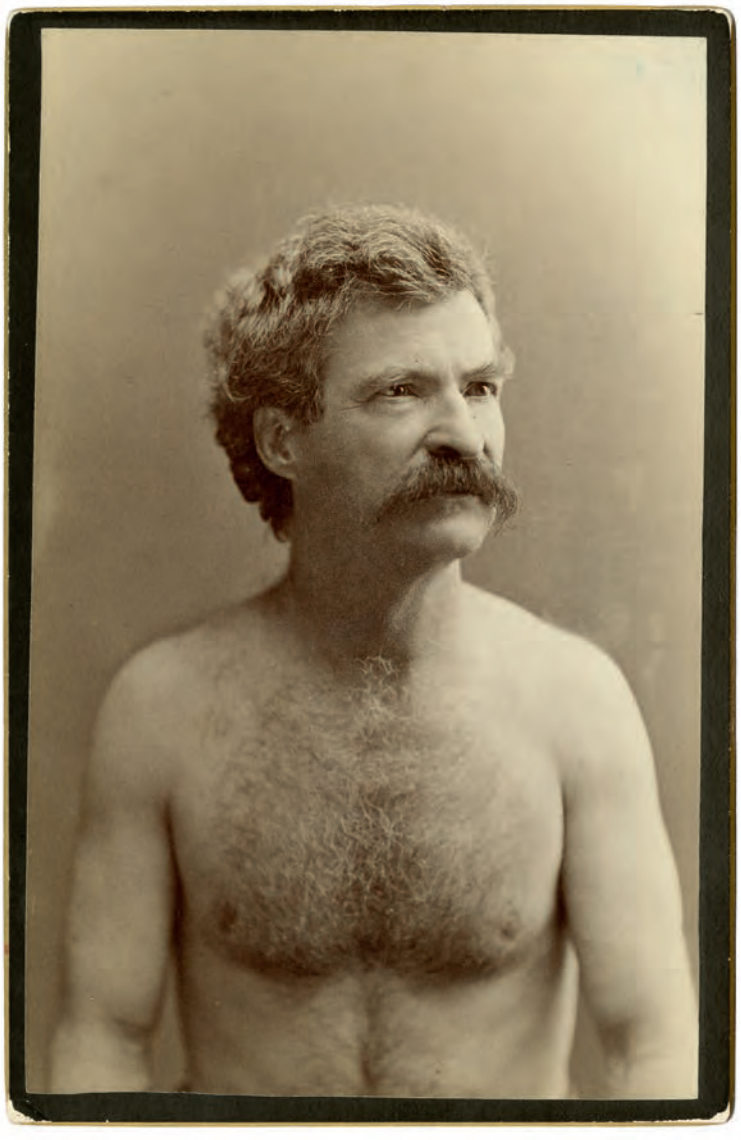
Robert is survived by his wife, Susan; his sons, Alex and Thomas Montgomery; and his grandsons, Charles and Daniel.

For In Memoriam guidelines, please visit *alumni.berkeley.edu/submission-guidelines/#memoriam*. We prefer that you email submissions to obits@alumni.berkeley.edu with "Obituary: first name, last name, class year" in the subject line, but you can also mail a hard copy to In Memoriam, *California* magazine, CAA, 1 Alumni House, Berkeley, CA 94720-7520. Submissions may be edited for length and clarity.

Submissions deadline:
Winter 2026: October 1, 2026

Collections

Photograph of Samuel L. Clemens Shirtless



This 1884 gelatin print—one of many oddities housed in the Mark Twain Papers and Project of the Bancroft Library—was likely made as a reference image for a sculptor who was working on a bust of the famous author. In the archivist's clinically precise description, it depicts: "Clemens, Samuel, L. Front view of torso, three-quarter view of head. Naked."

Naked, indeed. And surprisingly buff, even at age 48.

The bust itself was photographed and served as a frontispiece in *Adventures of Huckleberry Finn*, published the same year.

Twain was friendly with the young sculptor, Karl Gerhardt, and his wife, Harriet. On their first meeting, "Hattie" insisted on showing him a topless sculpture of herself that Karl had made. Twain later wrote to a friend, "it will be many a long day before I run across another woman who can do the like & show no trace of self-consciousness." As for Karl, Twain considered him so talented that he sent the 28-year-old to Paris and paid for three years of his artistic training.

The once-obscure photo has become a source of some amusement online, usually paired with one of Twain's aphorisms: "Clothes make the man. Naked people have little or no influence." Fewer know the story of the author's generosity—another topic Twain quipped about. "Never refuse to do a kindness unless the act would work great injury to yourself, and never refuse to take a drink—under any circumstances."

—J.P.T.

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